

WELLMOBE: Barriers to International Student Mobility

Project overview, interactive tool, and key findings

04 July 2026

What this project is about

This survey investigates why some students choose international mobility (Erasmus and similar programmes) while others – even when motivated – do not follow through. The goal is to provide partner universities with evidence-based insights to improve their support for student mobility.

Survey coverage

- Multiple partner universities across Europe
- Questionnaire covering: socio-demographic background, financial situation, language skills, parental capital, psychological profile, and perceived barriers to mobility
- Core analytical question: **what differentiates students who act on their desire for mobility from those who do not?**



Indicator	Value
Total respondents	1230
Universities represented	4
Respondents with complete group classification	1230
Group 1 — Already gone	260 (21.1%)
Group 2 — Wants to go & applied	119 (9.7%)
Group 3 — Wants to go (not applied)	200 (16.3%)
Group 4 — Does not want to go	651 (52.9%)

What is Mobility Insights?

Mobility Insights is a free, open-access interactive dashboard built on the survey data. It allows partner universities to:

- Upload their own Excel data file
- Visualise descriptive statistics for their students
- Compare their university to the full sample
- Identify groups of students and their profiles
- View automatically computed policy warning indicators

All data stays local — nothing is sent to a server. Each university works with its own data in its own browser

Access the tool

[your GitHub Pages URL]

Format: .xlsx or .xls

Requirements: any modern browser

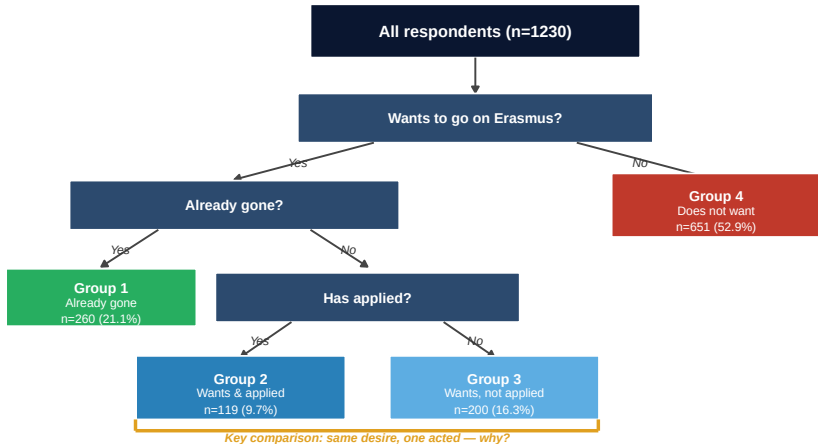
No installation needed

A note on AI

The dashboard code was built with the assistance of Claude (Anthropic). This is disclosed in the tool's "About" section.

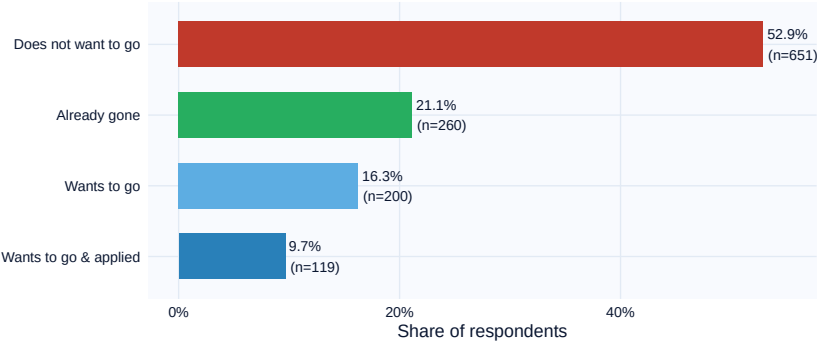
Tab	Description
Overview	Group distribution and mobility funnel
Socio-demographics	Gender, study level, geographic area by group
Academic & language	Normalized grade, certified English level by group
Financial profile	Financial comfort (1=very comfortable, 5=not at all), income, scholarship
Parental capital	Parental education and parental Erasmus participation
International & psycho	International profile score (0-10) and 7 psychological dimensions
Barriers to mobility	Mean score per barrier (1-5), Likert distributions, differentiating barriers
Reasons for going	Reasons for going — Group 1 only
Group 2 vs 3	Profile comparison between applicants and non-applicants
Universities	Group composition across all loaded universities
Statistical tests	Chi ² , Kruskal-Wallis, Mann-Whitney significance tests
Policy Warnings	 Automatically computed indicators with policy recommendations
About	Methodology, AI disclosure, data privacy

How Groups Are Defined

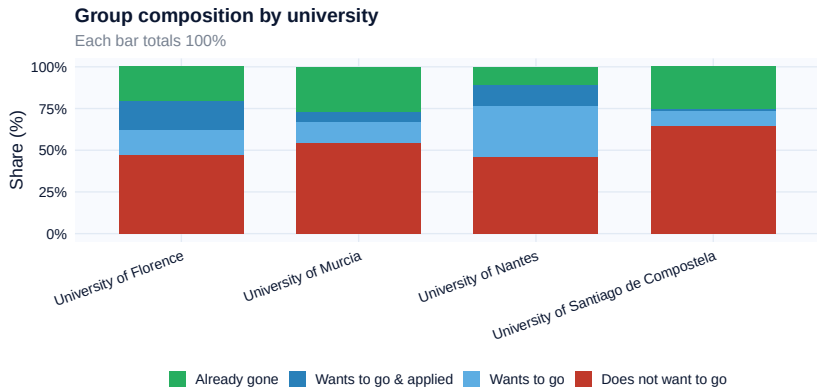




Distribution of the four mobility groups

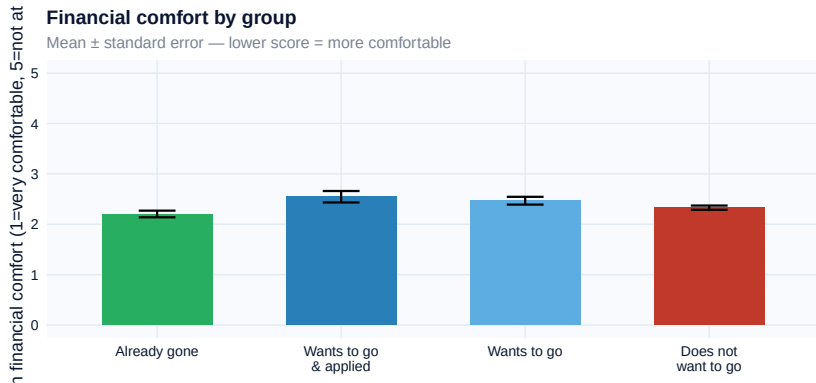


Finding 1 — Group Composition Varies by University



The share of students who want to go but have not applied (Group 3) varies substantially across partner universities — highlighting that local context and institutional support matter.

Finding 2 — Financial Profile Differs Between Groups

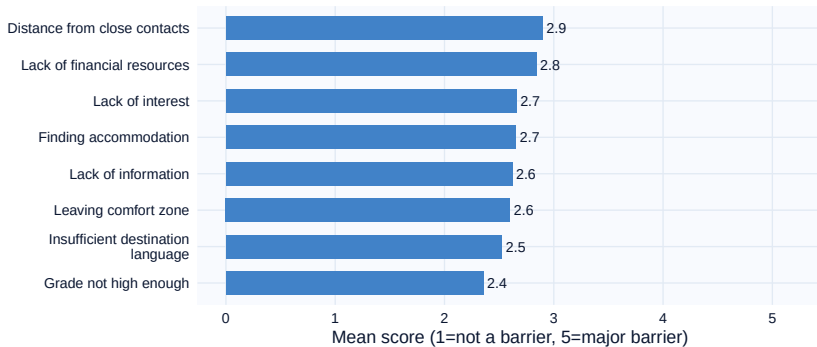


Students who do not want to go report slightly lower financial comfort on average. Within motivated students, Group 3 (not applied) tends to report higher financial difficulty than Group 2 (applied).

Finding 3 — Top Barriers to Mobility

Top 8 barriers to mobility (full sample)

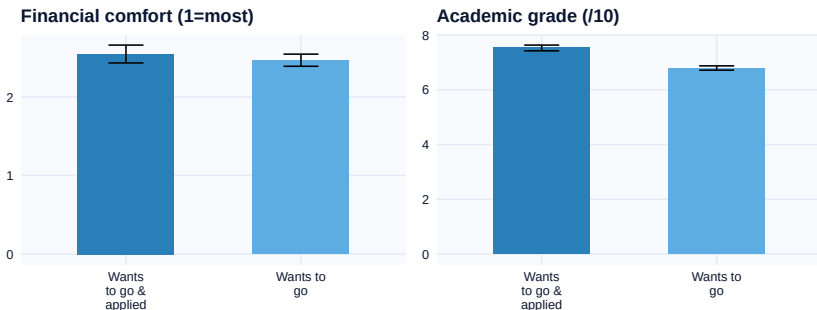
Average rating across all respondents who answered these items



Finding 4 — Group 2 vs Group 3: Who Acts on Intent?

Group 2 (applied) vs Group 3 (not applied) — selected variables

Mean $\pm$ SE. Key question: what differentiates students with the same desire for mobility?



Groups 2 and 3 share the same desire to go. Differences in financial situation, academic profile, and psychological variables suggest that the barrier to applying is not lack of motivation but structural constraints.

What this tool enables

- Each university can upload its own data and explore its specific profile
- The comparison feature allows benchmarking against the full multi-university sample
- The **Policy Warnings** tab flags situations requiring attention with suggested actions

Planned developments

- Integration of public policy indicators (to be defined collaboratively)
- Additional universities and longitudinal data
- Domain name and institutional branding
- Review of analytical framework by all partners